

Trump visits Ohio to support Husted in close Senate race

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President Donald Trump was heading to Ohio on Saturday, October 3, 2026, for a campaign rally near Dayton. His visit aimed to support Republican candidates ahead of the November 3 elections, including Senator Jon Husted, who faces Democrat Sherrod Brown in a closely watched race.

Husted was **appointed** to the Senate after JD Vance left his seat to become vice president. Now Husted is running to win the seat in an election. Brown, who served three terms in the Senate, is trying to return after losing to Republican Bernie Moreno two years ago.

The Ohio contest matters because it could help decide which party controls the Senate. Democrats have identified Ohio as an important state for winning a **majority**. Senator Tim Scott, who leads the Senate Republicans' **campaign committee**, said this week that the race between Husted and Brown was about even.

The economy is another major campaign issue. Trump has argued at rallies that the economy is doing better than voters believe. However, polls show that Americans are unhappy with his handling of it. People in the Dayton area are concerned about living costs, and nearly 1,400 workers recently lost their jobs at a nearby Springfield truck factory.

The candidates also disagree over **data centers**. These large buildings hold computers that support services such as artificial intelligence. Some voters worry about their effects on electricity prices, farmland and water supplies.

Brown has criticized Husted's role in bringing **data centers** to Ohio, including **tax breaks** for technology companies. Scott defended Husted, saying he supports responsible development and would oppose a project if the community did not want it. Trump strongly supports **data centers**, arguing that they help the United States compete with China in artificial intelligence.

Ohio also has a close race for governor. Republican Vivek Ramaswamy, a business owner and former presidential candidate, faces Democrat Dr. Amy Acton, the state's former health director. Despite Ramaswamy's large **fundraising advantage**, the contest remains competitive with weeks left before voting day.

Word Treasure

appointed -- Chosen to fill a position rather than winning it in an election.

majority -- More than half of the seats or members in a group.

campaign committee -- A group that organizes support for candidates during elections.

data centers -- Large buildings containing computers that support services such as artificial intelligence.

tax breaks -- Measures that reduce the amount of tax a person or company must pay.

fundraising advantage -- Having raised more money for a campaign than an opponent.

Break it down

Lead: Trump's Ohio visit, the election date and the Husted-Brown contest.

Candidate background: Husted's appointment and Brown's previous Senate service and defeat.

National significance: The possible effect on Senate control and Scott's assessment of the race.

Economic concerns: Trump's argument, polling, living costs and factory job losses.

Data center debate: Voter concerns, Brown's criticism, Scott's defense and Trump's support.

Related contest: The competitive governor race between Ramaswamy and Acton.

Why it matters

The Ohio Senate contest could influence which party controls the Senate. Economic concerns and disagreements over data centers are major campaign issues, while the state also has a competitive governor race.

Test what you remember

1. When was Trump heading to Ohio for the campaign rally?
 - (A) October 3, 2026
 - (B) Two years before Brown's defeat
 - (C) After the November 3 elections
 - (D) November 3, 2026
2. Which Republican defeated Brown two years ago?
 - (A) Jon Husted
 - (B) Tim Scott
 - (C) Bernie Moreno
 - (D) JD Vance
3. How did Tim Scott describe the Husted-Brown race this week?
 - (A) Certain to be won by Brown
 - (B) No longer competitive
 - (C) Already won by Husted
 - (D) About even
4. What contrast does the article describe about the economy?
 - (A) Brown praises the economy, while Husted says the factory is hiring.
 - (B) Trump says the economy is doing better than voters believe, but polls show unhappiness with his handling of it.
 - (C) Scott says living costs have disappeared, while Trump disagrees.
 - (D) Acton says data centers have solved all concerns about jobs.
5. According to Scott, when would Husted oppose a data center project?
 - (A) Only after the governor election ended
 - (B) Whenever it involved computers
 - (C) Whenever it used artificial intelligence
 - (D) If the community did not want it
6. What does the article say about Ohio's governor race?
 - (A) It remains competitive despite Ramaswamy's large fundraising advantage.
 - (B) Acton has withdrawn from the contest.
 - (C) Brown has the largest fundraising advantage.
 - (D) Ramaswamy and Husted are competing for governor.

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: C 3: D 4: B 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **Democrats:** They identify Ohio as an important state for winning a Senate majority.
2. **Trump:** He argues that the economy is doing better than voters believe and that data centers help the United States compete with China in artificial intelligence.
3. **Brown:** He criticizes Husted's role in bringing data centers to Ohio, including tax breaks for technology companies.
4. **Scott's defense of Husted:** Scott says Husted supports responsible development and would oppose a project unwanted by the community.
5. **Voter concerns:** People in the Dayton area are concerned about living costs, and some voters worry about data centers' effects on electricity prices, farmland and water supplies.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):